

iPhones poses no significant difficulty for ReFit, thanks to the team of specialised engineers who possess extensive experience in repairing Apple devices. Some of these engineers have even acquired prior experience working in the repair departments of Apple and other prominent phone brands. ReFit ensures that their engineers are equipped with the necessary software and applications essential for the repair process.

Regarding the sourcing of parts, ReFit directly obtains them from both Indian and Chinese suppliers and local markets. The company adheres to the specific guidelines provided by the respective brands to ensure that only brand approved spare parts supported by these devices are utilised in the repair process. This ensures the quality and compatibility of the replaced components.

While ReFit maintains contacts with Apple Service for sourcing spare products, if required. But, it should be noted that ReFit is not affiliated with the Apple Self-Service Repair program.

Q With novelty devices of the yesteryears like foldable smartphones entering the mainstream, what changes does ReFit need to bring in terms of training and process when working with such devices?

A With the emergence of foldable smartphones in the mainstream market, ReFit acknowledges the presence of these novelty devices. However, it should be noted that the current inflow of foldable devices to ReFit constitutes less than 0.5% of their overall inventory. While some brands have introduced foldable devices, the volume of such devices received by ReFit remains relatively minimal.

Based on industry surveys, the demand for foldable devices is not expected to experience significant growth in the next few years. Therefore, ReFit does not anticipate a substantial increase in the influx of these devices. Foldable smartphones tend to be more of a style statement rather than being driven by practical utility. These devices

Are there any myths that you have come across from market research that is very prevalent in the Indian market? Especially around refurbished devices?

Through extensive market research, we have encountered several prevalent myths in the Indian market, particularly surrounding refurbished devices. It is crucial to raise consumer awareness about the distinctions between second-hand devices and refurbished devices. At ReFit Global, we strive to align our refurbishment process with the standards and requirements of new smartphones available in showrooms.

We aim to educate consumers and provide them with accurate information about refurbished devices. This includes clarifying the misconceptions surrounding the quality, reliability, trust of the refurbisher, performance of refurbished devices compared to second-hand devices. We emphasize our commitment to delivering refurbished devices that meet the same standards as new smartphones, ensuring customer satisfaction and dispelling any doubts they may have.

By addressing these prevalent myths, we contribute to a more informed consumer base, enabling individuals to make confident and well-informed decisions when considering refurbished devices as a reliable and cost-effective option.

require careful handling and are less durable compared to traditional smartphones. Given their fragility, ReFit understands the need for cautious treatment and acknowledges that these devices cannot withstand rough handling.

Nevertheless, if foldable devices become a more significant portion, the company is well-prepared. They have expert engineers who specialise in repairing such devices, possess the necessary equipment and tools, and have developed efficient processes to handle foldable phones with care.

However, it is worth mentioning that unless durable foldable devices enter the market, the current situation is not a significant concern for ReFit.

Q Lastly, what are some of the trends of the future, especially in the refurbishing business and consumer electronics market, does ReFit see becoming a reality?

A From ReFit's perspective, several trends are expected to shape the future of the refurbishing business and the consumer electronics market:

Increased Demand for Refurbished Devices: As consumers become more conscious of their environmental impact and seek cost-effective alternatives, the demand for refurbished devices is expected to rise. ReFit anticipates a surge in demand for refurbished smartphones, tablets, laptops, and other consumer electronics as consumers recognize the value and quality of these products.

Increase in competitors: From a competitive standpoint, the commerce industry will become increasingly competitive in the future. This is due to Increased Market Size, Increased demand, Technological advancements, Increased acceptance and trust.

Integration of AI: ReFit envisions the integration of AI in the refurbishing process. AI algorithms can assist in diagnostics, quality control, and predictive maintenance, enabling more efficient and accurate repairs. ReFit keeps a close eye on advancements in AI technology to stay at the forefront of industry trends. **■**